

Phishing Awareness Training

Cybersecurity Defense Module

"Know the threat. Stop the breach"

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What Is Phishing?



Phishing is a cyberattack where criminals impersonate trusted sources to steal sensitive data — passwords, financial info, or access credentials.



#1 Attack Vector

Over 90% of data breaches start with phishing



\$4.9B Lost

Global financial damage in 2023 alone



Targets Everyone

Employees, executives, and individuals alike

Types of Phishing Attacks



Email Phishing

Mass fake emails disguised as banks, HR, or IT departments



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted attack using your name, role, or company details



Smishing

SMS-based phishing — fake package alerts, bank texts, prize wins



Clone / Fake Sites

Pixel-perfect copies of real websites designed to harvest credentials



Vishing

Voice call fraud — attackers pose as IT support or IRS agents



Social Engineering Tactics

Attackers exploit **human psychology** — not just technology. These are the four core manipulation levers.

Urgency

"Your account will be locked in 2 hours — act now!"

Fear

"Suspicious login detected. Verify identity immediately."

Fake Authority

Impersonating CEO, IT admin, FBI, or IRS to demand action

Trust Exploitation

Using your name, colleague's name, or company branding to seem legitimate

How to Spot a Phishing Email



 Suspicious Sender Address
support@paypa1-secure.net ≠ paypal.com

 Grammar & Spelling Errors

Legitimate companies proofread —
attackers often don't

 Threatening or Urgent Language
"Immediate action required or account
deleted"

 Unknown Attachments or Links
Hover over links before clicking — check the
real URL

 Mismatched Domains
Display name says "Amazon" but link goes
elsewhere

Fake Website Detection



Typosquatting: attackers register domains that look like real ones — one letter off. Example: `arnazon.com` vs `amazon.com`



HTTPS means encrypted — but fake sites can have HTTPS too. Always verify the full URL.

When in doubt, **type the URL manually** into your browser — never click links in emails.

Real-World Examples

Fake Bank Email

From: `security@bankofamerica-alert.com`

"Your account has been compromised. Click here to verify within 24 hours or access will be permanently suspended."

- Spoofed sender domain
- Fear + urgency combo
- Link leads to credential-harvesting page

Fake Login Page

A cloned Microsoft 365 login page — visually identical to the real one.

- URL: `microsoft-login.com`
- Victim types credentials → attacker receives them instantly
- 2FA bypass possible if attacker acts fast



Real damage: Corporate email compromise, ransomware deployment, wire fraud

Prevention Best Practices

1

Enable MFA

Multi-Factor Authentication — requires a second proof of identity beyond your password (e.g., a code texted to your phone)

2

Never Click Unknown Links

Hover to preview URLs. When in doubt, go directly to the official website

3

Verify the Sender

Call the person directly using a known number — not one in the email

4

Use a Password Manager

A secure app that stores and auto-fills strong, unique passwords — e.g., Bitwarden, 1Password

5

Keep Systems Updated

Patches fix security holes that attackers exploit. Enable auto-updates

Knowledge Check — Quiz

Test what you've learned. Select the best answer for each question.

1

Q1: An email says "Your account will be closed in 1 hour." What should you do?

 **Correct:** Go directly to the official website by typing the URL — do NOT click the email link

2

Q2: A website URL reads "arnazon.com." Is it safe?

 **Correct:** No — this is typosquatting. The real site is amazon.com. Close it immediately

3

Q3: A caller says they're from IT and needs your password. What do you do?

 **Correct:** Refuse. Legitimate IT staff will never ask for your password — this is vishing

4

Q4: A site has HTTPS and a padlock. Is it definitely safe?

 **Correct:** No — HTTPS only means the connection is encrypted, not that the site is legitimate

5

Q5: You receive an unexpected invoice attachment from your "CEO." What's the risk?

 **Correct:** This is likely spear phishing — verify via phone before opening any attachment



Conclusion

Humans Are the Last Line of Defense

Technology can block many threats — but **awareness stops the ones that slip through.**

Stay Skeptical

Pause before clicking. Question urgency. Verify identity.

Stay Informed

Threats evolve daily. Regular training = stronger defense.

Report Suspicious Activity

Always report to your IT/Security team — fast reporting limits damage.



You've completed the Phishing Awareness Training Module. **Share this knowledge — every employee is a security asset.**